

Sushant Singh

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Education

Ph.D., Economics (Econometrics and Quantitative Economics) Expected 2026

University of Oklahoma, USA

Dissertation: “Three essays on food sovereignty, pollution havens, and international sanctions”

Committee: Firat Demir (chair), Pallab Ghosh, Jayash Paudel, Annabel Ipsen

M.Sc., Economics (Economic Policy) 2018

University of Neuchâtel, Switzerland

Advisor: Jean-Marie Grether

B.Com Hons. (Finance and Investment) 2014

Christ University, India

Employment

Graduate Assistant Aug 2021–present

University of Oklahoma

National Consultant March 2018–July 2021

International Trade Center (UN/WTO)

Research Assistant Oct 2017–Jan 2018

Institute of Economic Research at Neuchâtel (IRENE)

Research Interests

International Economics, Development Economics, Environmental Economics.

Job Market Paper

“Structural adjustments and food sovereignty: The effects of IMF programs and loan conditions on food self-sufficiency”

In this paper I study the effects of IMF program participation and associated policy conditions, known as ‘conditionalities,’ on food self-sufficiency of IMF members for the period of 1980-2019. In the empirical analysis, I employ a compound instrumental variable approach within a system of three equations, estimated using maximum likelihood. After accounting for confounding economic and climatic factors and addressing selection bias, I find no robust evidence that IMF program participation has any effect on food self-sufficiency. In contrast, program conditions have a significant effect on food self sufficiency. Based on point estimates, I find that each additional binding IMF condition reduces the food self-sufficiency ratio by 0.003 percentage points. Disaggregating conditions by policy area, the findings suggest that IMF conditionality hinders food self-sufficiency, with policy reforms in trade and exchange systems, financial sectors, monetary policy, and central banking playing a particularly significant role.

Research Papers

Working Papers:

- [1] “How international sanctions shape the carbon footprint of global trade?”
- [2] “Revisiting the pollution haven hypothesis and trade-embodied emissions: Accounting for global value chains.”

Grants, Fellowships & Awards

Alexander J. Kondonassis Award for research in Development Economics (x2) University of Oklahoma	2023 & 2025
Dodge Family College of Arts and Sciences Dissertation Fellowship University of Oklahoma (\$11,845)	2025
Graduate Student Senate Conference Grant University of Oklahoma (\$600)	2024
Dodge Family College of Arts and Sciences Travel Grant University of Oklahoma (\$750)	2024

Conference & Seminar Presentations

† Session Chair; * Presenter & Discussant.

2026: Midwest Economics Association - MEA - 90th Annual Meeting* (Chicago, Illinois), Allied Social Sciences Association - ASSA - 2026 Annual Meeting† (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania)

2025: Southern Economic Association - SEA - 95th Annual Meeting* (Tampa, Florida), North American Regional Science Council - NARSC - 72nd Annual Meeting* (Denver, Colorado), Missouri Valley Economic Association - MVEA - 62nd Annual Meeting* (Kansas City, Missouri)

2024: North American Regional Science Council - NARSC - 71st Annual Meeting† (New Orleans, Louisiana), Missouri Valley Economic Association - MVEA - 61st Annual Meeting* (Kansas City, Missouri), OU PhD Econ Conference -OPEC (Norman, Oklahoma)

2023: OU PhD Econ Conference -OPEC (Norman, Oklahoma)

Teaching Experience

University of Oklahoma

- ECON 1113 Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate) – Summer 2024, Summer 2023
- ECON 1123 Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate) – Winter 2023-24

Apex College (Pokhara University), Nepal

- ECO 101 Introductory Microeconomics (BBA, Undergraduate) – June 2019–July 2021
- ECO 201 Introductory Macroeconomics (BBA, Undergraduate) – June 2019–July 2021

Islington College (London Metropolitan University), Nepal

- EC5002NI International Business and World Markets (BBA, Undergraduate) – Sep 2018-Feb 2019
- EC4009NI Corporate Environment (BBA, Undergraduate) – Sep 2018-Feb 2019

Skills

Coding Expertise: Stata, R, L^AT_EX

Coding Experience: Julia, ArcGIS, Python, MATLAB, Git, Mathematica

Languages: Nepali (native), English (fluent), Hindi (fluent), French (basic)

Service & Professional Activities

Memberships: American Economic Association (2025-present), Southern Economic Association (2025-present), Regional Science Association International (2024-present)

References

Firat Demir

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Pallab Ghosh

Associate Professor
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Jayash Paudel

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Samantha R. Johnson (Teaching)

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Last updated: May 24, 2026